

Build an End-to-End “Publisher” Agent

From keyword research to a published page — without leaving your terminal. Endorsed by Zak Ali, GM of Finder US.

Who it's for: SEO/content teams ready to move the commodity part of publishing to an AI agent so humans can spend time on the things AI can't do — original research, video, and community.

Objective

Stand up a single AI agent that takes a topic from keyword research all the way to a published CMS page, run from your terminal — then reinvest the reclaimed time into the work that actually differentiates you.

Key Steps

1. **Set up the terminal environment.** Run an agent in the terminal (e.g. Claude Code) and connect an SEO-data MCP (Ahrefs / OpenSEO) plus your CMS credentials.
2. **Build a “second brain.”** In Obsidian markdown, capture your process, decision log, brand + voice profile, and ICP. The agent reads this every run (and it keeps you model-agnostic).
3. **Seed & research keywords.** Start from a real conversation, then validate/expand via the MCP.
4. **Build the customer profile + brief + outline.**
5. **Competitor + deep research.** Have the agent gather well-cited supporting research.
6. **Draft → human edit → internal linking.** Keep a human on the brief and the edit; let the agent handle drafting and internal links.
7. **Publish to the CMS from the terminal** (e.g. WordPress) — no context-switch.
8. **Add a judgment ledger.** Log the agent's decisions; when one doesn't pan out, write the correction back so the system compounds.
9. **Reinvest the time.** Push the humans toward YouTube, guest posts, and community — the lifetime-value work.

Cautionary Notes

- Don't drift into **scaled-content abuse** — this is about reclaiming time for quality & information gain, not spraying pages.
- Keep a **human on the strategy layer** (the brief and the edit). The agent executes; it doesn't decide what's worth making.
- Agents break in **new ways a human delegate wouldn't** — document edge cases so the workflow survives.

Tips for Efficiency

- Make it **model-agnostic** — context lives in the second brain, not one model, so Opus/Sonnet/Fable are interchangeable.
- **Repeatability is scalability** — force the agent to log every step so a great one-off becomes a template.
- Once one agent works, run **several in parallel**.

Source

Zak Ali, General Manager, Finder US — on the **Unscripted SEO** podcast. “You don’t even have to leave your terminal to do your entire job.”